

IIMARP/PG/08/98
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To Custodial Services Division,
HSBC/DEUTSCHE BANK/CITIBANK/
STANDARD CHARTERED BANK/SBI/
ILFS LTD/MSTC/HDFC BANK/
ANZ GRINDLAYS BANK/ICICI LTD/
VIJAYA BANK/SIDS LTD/IIT CORP.SERV./SHCIL

Sub: Specifications of vaults with custodians

Custodians are holdings securities of considerable value on behalf of their clients. It is expected that they would take adequate measures to ensure their safety. In this regard, you are requested to submit the specifications of your vaults along with their size. A copy of RBI specifications for construction of vaults is also enclosed for your perusal.

Yours faithfully,

NEETA PIMPALE

Encl: as above

Compendium of Instructions - Construction
Specifications of A, B and C Class
(portable) currency chest Strong Rooms
and allied matters

Presently, currency chests are classified as 'A', 'B' and 'C' class chest. The requisite standards of construction are produced below:

- 1) 'A' Class Currency Chest
Walls, roof and floor for
new strong room

45 cm (18") thick 1:1 1/2:3 R.C.C. fortified with 2 rows of tang bars 23 cm. wide and 3 mm. thick in all the walls, floor and roof.

For existing strong rooms which are to be improved to conform to standard specifications, the walls, roof and floor should be 45 cm (18") thick, being constructed with steel plates of 3/8" thickness or heavily reinforced concrete or with both.

Door

In either type of strong room, if a specification for a heavier type of vault door, appropriate to 18" R.C.C. walls is issued by the Indian Standard Institution (ISI), the vault doors will be provided according to this specification. If such ISI specification has not been issued, the vault doors manufactured by Godrej & Boyce Manufacturing Co. Ltd. or Steelage Industries Ltd. of following specification would be considered suitable for A Class strong room. Door slab shall be of 65 mm. thickness and above, fabricated out of special steel plates or slabs and hammer, drill, oxy-acetylene, blow pipe resisting armour plates. The thickness of hammer and drill resisting alloy plates in one or more layers, shall not be less than 16 mm. (5/8" and that of oxy-

acetylene blow pipe resisting copper alloy plates, in one or more layers shall not be less than 10 mm. (3/8"). The total thickness of door slab including cover shall, however, be equivalent in strength to the strength of 45 cm. thick RCC walls fortified with two rows of tang bars. Locks and other vital parts shall be further shielded by armour plates to withstand prolonged attack by tools of any description. A bank constructing a new building or undertaking the renovation or remodelling of an existing building (i.e. in all buildings owned by the bank), a superior type of the strong room of the above specifications may be provided within the building where currency chest is proposed.

2. 'B' class currency chest

It will normally be sanctioned only in rented building or existing buildings owned by the banks if it is proved that the walls and floors of these existing buildings cannot, for any reasons, bear the load of the heavy 'A' class type of strong room. The specifications for the 'B' class strong room will be as follows.

Walls : R.C.C. 1:2:4
30 cm. (12") thick

Floor : R.C.C. 1:2:4

15 cm. (6") thick heavily reinforced over the existing plain, cement concrete flooring for vaults in ground floor and over existing R.C.C. slabs in vaults in upper floor (the strength of the slab in such case will have to be checked to allow for the additional dead and superimposed load).

Ceiling: R.C.C. 1:2:4
30 cm. (12") thick.

Door: According to the specifications in the standard for the lower bankers' quality strong room door, to be issued by the ISI or until this standard is issued; either a door of the quality specified for 'A' class currency chests or a door with a slab which is at least 28 mm. over rebates (including a drill resisting layer of 6 mm. and an anti

3. Reinforcements

As regards the reinforcement stated in paragraphs 1 and 2 above, minimum reinforcements as indicated below may be provided.

Walls : 12 mm. dia mild steel/tor steel at 6" centre to centre both ways and on both faces of the wall (a formation of reinforcement matt (of about 6"x6") on either face of the wall to be obtained.

Floor : Same as in the case of walls but only on one face.

Ceiling: Same as in the case of walls.

Further, where reinforcement is proposed on two faces of a R.C.C. member, it shall be staggered in such a manner that any view taken at right angles to the matt formation would show reinforcement at every 3" centre to centre in elevation (in respect of walls) and in plain (in respect of ceiling slab).

4. 'C' class Currency Chests

"C" class Currency Chests will be located in premises, whether owned or leased by a bank, in which for any reason an 'A' or 'B' class strong room cannot be provided, but the bank finds it necessary and is willing to install portable strong rooms as an alternative to ordinary strong rooms. The portable strong room for 'C' class currency chest should be fire and burglar resisting and should be built of 10 mm. (3/8") best quality solid steel plates, held together by means of 4" x 4" angle section at corners, and 3" x 3" x 3/8" angle sections or 6" x 1/2" along with middle joints or with comparable reinforcement at suitable places. The strong room may be in the size of

11' x 8' x 8' or 15' x 8' x 8' and may be erected on concrete platforms within separate rooms constructed in the ordinary manner, to be locked from outside. The strong rooms of this type manufactured by M/s. Godrej & Boyce Manufacturing Co. Ltd. and M/s. Steelage Industries Ltd. would be satisfactory to the Bank. The banks may enhance the fire resisting potentiality of the portable strong-rooms by reinforcing them with brick-wallings.

5. The following requirements should also be kept in view while constructing/locating the strong rooms for currency chests.

i) A minimum floor area of 400 sq.ft. for 'A' class currency chests and 300 sq.ft. for 'B' class chest respectively is suggested. However, the banks should not restrict the area to bare minimum but as far as possible, should construct the strong rooms or larger area in the new premises constructed by them, to meet the future needs for storage of larger quantity of note-forms/coins.

ii) A patrol corridor around the vault is necessary for effective supervision by armed guards. Where the buildings are contiguous (i.e. having common walls with adjoining properties), the strong room should be little away from the common wall to allow a patrol corridor, to enable surveillance against penetration from adjoining property. However, provision of patrol corridor will not be insisted upon for 'A' and 'B' class currency chests where no wall of the strong room proposed for setting up a currency chest is common with any adjoining property, not in the possession and occupation of the bank concerned, as long as there is a strip of unbuilt land adjoining strong ...5.

room wall which could serve as a patrol corridor so as to enable the guards to detect penetration from the sides.

iii) Where the Currency Chest is intended to be located in rented premises, in which upper or lower floor is in the possession of other parties the location cannot be considered suitable unless space can be left in between the chest floor and floor slab or roof of chest and roof slab, so as to enable the guards to detect penetration from below or above the strong room.

iv) Where a Currency Chest is proposed on an existing suspended R.C.C. slab, since the additional load likely to come on the slab would be more than double the standard superimposed load as stipulated in I.S.I. specifications, the structural strength needs to be verified so as to ensure that the slab and beams are capable of supporting the load in question.

v) Where it is intended to provide grills as additional fortification to the ceiling slabs, they may preferably be so placed as to give a clear height of 9'0" so as to enable placing of bins of the size of 8'6" x 6'0" x 2'5". This point may be borne in mind while drawing the plans.

vi) Currency Chest should not be located in basements in areas likely to be affected by floods. In areas, with high ground water table, vaults in basements may be considered with care as these will be prone to seepage, dampness, etc.

viii) The electric circuit may be so taken via the vault door switch that the power supply is cut off

once the door is closed. Alternatively, socket outlets could be provided on both faces of the vault walls and supply electricity through a flex with 2 plugs which can be used only when the vault door remains open.

viii) Provision should be made for rest room for the armed police guards. Where the guards room is not in close proximity to the Currency Chest it may be so located as to enable the guards to reach the vault unhindered in case of necessity.

ix) If ventilators are necessary only those of security type manufactured by M/s. Godrej & Boyce Manufacturing Co. Ltd. or M/s. Steelage Industries Ltd. should be used. No other type of ventilator is permissible.